

School of Interdisciplinary Studies

Interdisciplinary Studies (BS)

The Bachelor's degrees in Interdisciplinary Studies (BAIS) emphasize a broad learning experience and a wider perspective than that provided by traditional undergraduate majors. They are designed to offer the student the opportunity to participate in an interdisciplinary, coherent, academically sound, and goal-oriented education directly relevant to the student's intellectual development and career aspirations. They are appropriate for those students who seek a thorough grounding in the traditional arts and sciences from an interdisciplinary perspective. Each student in the Interdisciplinary Studies program becomes an active partner in the formulation of his or her program of study, working in consultation with an academic advisor to devise an appropriate individual degree plan. Within the framework of two foundation areas, a university-wide Interdisciplinary Studies sequence, and a multidisciplinary concentration, a student may draw upon the resources of all schools of the University to create a degree program.

Common areas of concentration for the BAIS are business issues, environmental studies, human resources, international relations, law, public relations, and urban studies. Graduates have been accepted into graduate programs in divinity, education, environmental studies, the health professions, humanities, interdisciplinary studies, law, management, and social sciences. The BS in Interdisciplinary Studies is selected by students interested in environmental studies, the health professions, and other science-related fields. Students interested in pre-health are advised to contact the Head of Healthcare Studies during their first semester.

Minors and Double Majors are not allowed in these two Interdisciplinary Studies degrees. In order to make the Interdisciplinary Studies degrees reflect their name, no more than 21 semester credit hours of courses with the same prefix are allowed in the combined major requirements and the 6 semester credit hours of electives. (All courses taught by the Naveen Jindal School of Management courses count as a single prefix.) In the major requirements and 6 semester credit hours of electives, the plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours. In the concentration, a minimum of three (3) prefixes must be represented. Please consult an academic advisor for further elaboration.

The BAIS and BSIS are geared toward non-Education majors. For those students who wish to pursue a future in the field of Education, UT Dallas offers both a [Bachelor's of Arts in Education](#) and a [Bachelor's of Science in Education](#) through the School of Interdisciplinary Studies.

Bachelor of Science in Interdisciplinary Studies

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

Faculty

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Professors: Erin A. Smith

Professor of Instruction: Tonja Wissinger

Associate Professors of Instruction: Kathleen Byrnes, Patricia A. Leek

Assistant Professors of Instruction: Leah Goudy, Kyle Hammonds, Ruth Johnson, June Jones, Marc Lusk, Michele McNeel, Azadeh Stark, Chelsea Taylor, Larissa Werhnyak

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[MATH 1325](#) Applied Calculus I

[MATH 2413](#) Differential Calculus

[MATH 2417](#) Calculus I

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Choose two courses from the following:

[ISNS 2359](#) Earthquakes and Volcanoes¹

[ISNS 2367](#) The Oceans¹

[ISNS 2368](#) Weather and Climate¹

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[AMS 2300](#) American Popular Culture

[AMS 2341](#) American Studies for the Twenty-First Century

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[GST 2300](#) Introduction to Gender Studies

[PSY 2301](#) Introduction to Psychology

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses.²

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Choose one of the following courses in mathematics:

[MATH 1326](#) Applied Calculus II (if [MATH 1325](#) is taken)

[MATH 2414](#) Integral Calculus

or [MATH 2415](#) Calculus of Several Variables (if [MATH 2413](#) is taken)

[MATH 2419](#) Calculus II (if [MATH 2417](#) is taken)

and [MATH 2415](#) Calculus of Several Variables

Or select any course from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses.² (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 61 semester credit hours

[BIS 1100](#) Interdisciplinary Studies First Year Experience

Major Core Courses: 18 semester credit hours

[BIS 3320](#) The Nature of Intellectual Inquiry

One 3 semester credit hour [ISIS](#) course

One 3 semester credit hour [AMS](#), [GST](#), or [ISIS](#), or [BIS 4V04](#)

Any three ISNS science courses¹

Major Related Courses: 42 semester credit hours consisting of:

Two Foundations: 12 semester credit hours each (24 semester credit hours)

Foundation I consists of courses taught by the School of Natural Sciences and Mathematics, Erik Jonsson School of Engineering and Computer Science, or Science courses from the School of Behavioral and Brain Sciences (NSC and CGS only).

Foundation II is drawn from the courses taught by the Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology; the School of Behavioral and Brain Sciences (if not used for Foundation I); the Erik Jonsson School of Engineering and Computer Science (if not used in Foundation I); the School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences; the School of Interdisciplinary Studies; and the Naveen Jindal School of Management.

One Concentration: 18 semester credit hours

Each student devises, in consultation with his/her advisor, the topic for the Concentration and selects 18 semester credit hours of coursework related to the topic, drawn from at least three academic disciplines. Appropriate IS coursework may be selected. Three courses must be science courses and one must be a statistics course.

Environmental Studies Concentration

Requirements differ depending on medical career choice. Must incorporate three science courses and a statistics course

Courses listed may have prerequisites, co-requisites, or preparatory courses to register for the course.

[ECON 4332](#) Energy and Natural Resources Economics

[ECON 4333](#) Environmental Economics

[GEOG 2302](#) The Global Environment

[GEOS 2302](#) The Global Environment

[GEOS 3421](#) Sedimentary Systems

[GEOS 3470](#) Structural Geology

[GEOS 4430](#) Hydrogeology and Aqueous Geochemistry

[ISNS 2359](#) Earthquakes and Volcanoes

[ISNS 2367](#) The Oceans

[ISNS 2368](#) Weather and Climate

[IPEC 3349](#) World Resources and Development

[PA 3310](#) Managing Government Organizations

[PSCI 3310](#) Managing Government Organizations

[PA 4345](#) Negotiation and Conflict Resolution

Pre-Medicine Concentration

It is recommended that students meet with a Healthcare Studies advisor or an advisor from the Health Professions Advising Center (HPAC). Requirements differ depending on medical career choice. must incorporate three science courses and a statistics course

Courses listed may have prerequisites, co-requisites, or preparatory courses to register for the course.

[BIOL 2311](#) Introduction to Modern Biology I

[BIOL 2111](#) Introduction to Modern Biology Workshop I

[BIOL 2312](#) Introduction to Modern Biology II

[BIOL 2112](#) Introduction to Modern Biology Workshop II

[BIOL 2281](#) Introductory Biology Laboratory

[BIOL 3402](#) Molecular and Cell Biology

[BIOL 3303](#) Introduction to Microbiology

[BIOL 3203](#) Introduction to Microbiology Lab

[BIOL 3461](#) Biochemistry I

[BIOL 3462](#) Biochemistry II

[BIOL 3455](#) Human Anatomy and Physiology with Lab I

[BIOL 3456](#) Human Anatomy and Physiology with Lab II

[CHEM 1311](#) General Chemistry I

[CHEM 1111](#) General Chemistry Laboratory I

[CHEM 1312](#) General Chemistry II

[CHEM 1112](#) General Chemistry Laboratory II

[CHEM 2323](#) Introductory Organic Chemistry I

[CHEM 2123](#) Introductory Organic Chemistry Laboratory I

[CHEM 2325](#) Introductory Organic Chemistry II

[CHEM 2125](#) Introductory Organic Chemistry Laboratory II

[CHEM 3341](#) Inorganic Chemistry I

[ECON 3330](#) Economics of Health

[HIST 3328](#) History and Philosophy of Science and Medicine

[HLTH 1100](#) Career Explorations for the Health Professions

[HLTH 1322](#) Human Nutrition

[HLTH 3300](#) Pre-Health Professional Development

[HLTH 3101](#) Medical Terminology

[HLTH 4380](#) Special Topics in Healthcare

[NSC 4351](#) Medical Neuroscience

[PHYS 1301](#) College Physics I

[PHYS 1101](#) College Physics Laboratory I

[PHYS 1302](#) College Physics II

[PHYS 1102](#) College Physics Laboratory II

[PSY 4328](#) Health Psychology

[SOC 4371](#) Mental Health and Illness

[SOC 4372](#) Health and Illness

[STAT 3332](#) Statistics for Life Sciences

[STAT 3360](#) Probability and Statistics for Management and Economics

III. Elective Requirements: 17 semester credit hours

Free Electives: 17 semester credit hours

A minimum of 45 semester credit hours must be taken at UT Dallas. All the coursework in the final semester must be taken at UT Dallas.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Honors in Interdisciplinary Studies (BS)

Grade Point Average (GPA): 3.900 cumulative GPA, 3.900 GPA in courses described below, and a total of 30 upper-division UT Dallas semester credit hours as described below.

Required courses: 9 semester credit hours

[BIS 3320](#) The Nature of Intellectual Inquiry (3 semester credit hours)

Foundation I - Natural Science and Mathematics (6 semester credit hours)

Concentration: 15 semester credit hours

Options (6 semester credit hours)

6 semester credit hours of Internship

or 3 semester credit hours of Internship and one three semester credit hour [AMS/GST/ISIS](#) course

1. A required major course that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in the Core Curriculum.

2. Students are strongly encouraged to take core courses that are closely related to their

foundations, concentrations, and career goals.

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